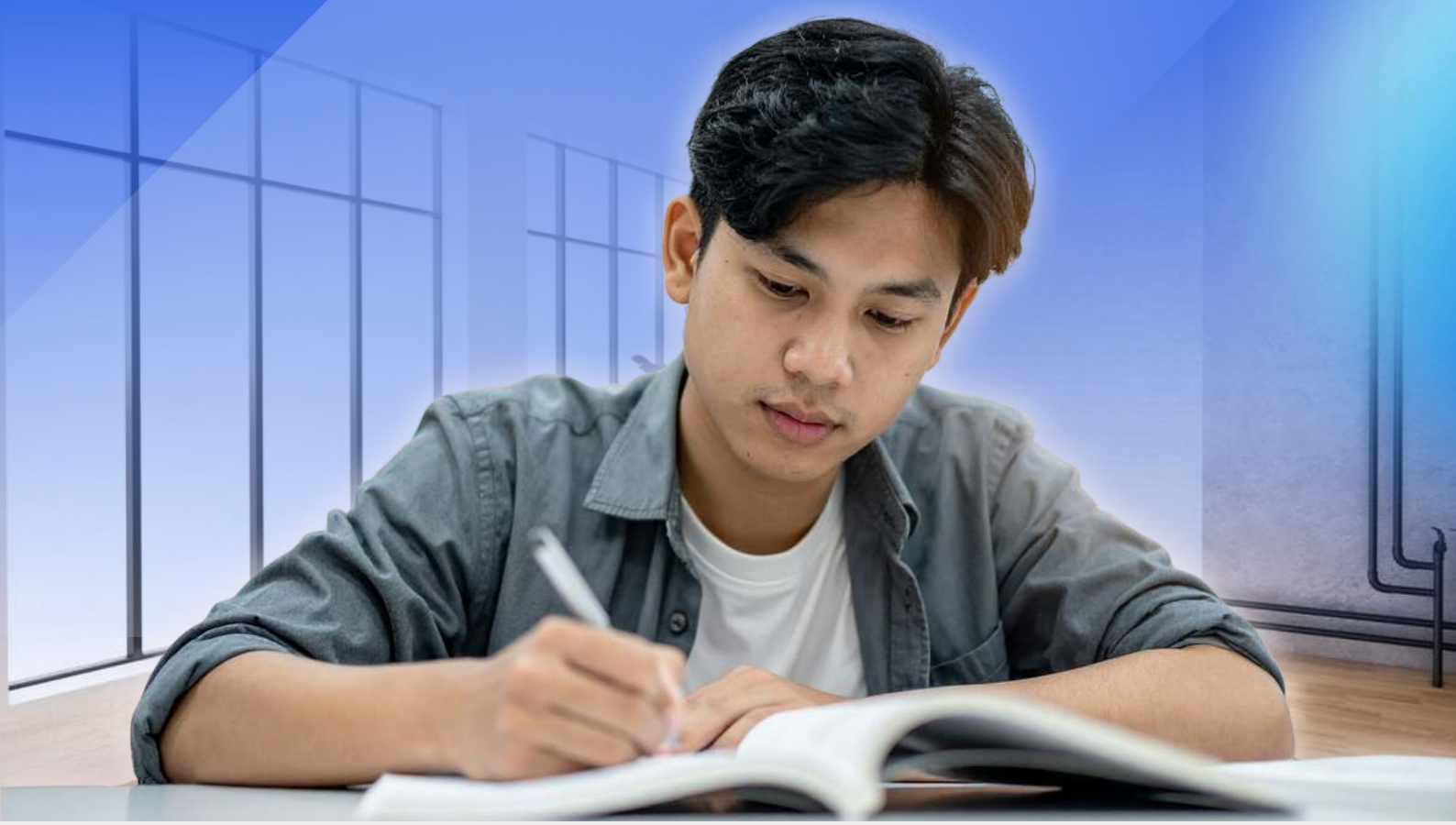
Lenterago

TRY OUT #3

SAT-Reading Writing

61004

54 QUESTIONS



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MODULE 1: Reading and Writing (27 Questions)

Directions:

The questions in this section address a number of important reading and writing skills. Each question includes one or more passages, which may include a table or graph. Read each passage and question carefully, and then choose the best answer to the question based on the passage(s).

All questions in this section are multiple-choice with four answer choices. Each question has a single best answer.

1. Recent archaeological findings at the Çatalhöyük site in Turkey have challenged long-held assumptions about early human settlements. Contrary to previous theories that depicted Neolithic societies as strictly hierarchical, evidence from Çatalhöyük suggests a remarkably egalitarian social structure. Analysis of residential units shows minimal variation in size and contents, indicating that wealth and status differences were minimal. Additionally, burial practices reveal no significant distinctions based on gender or social standing.
   Which choice best states the main idea of the text?
   A. Archaeological research at Çatalhöyük has proven all previous theories about Neolithic societies completely wrong.
   B. The burial practices at Çatalhöyük were unique among Neolithic settlements in the region.
   C. Findings from Çatalhöyük indicate that its residents likely lived in a relatively egalitarian society.
   D. Residential units at Çatalhöyük were remarkable for their uniform size and construction.
2. The development of the James Webb Space Telescope represented a monumental engineering challenge that required numerous technological innovations. One significant advancement was the creation of the telescope's segmented primary mirror, composed of 18 hexagonal beryllium segments that unfold after launch. Each segment is coated with a thin layer of gold to optimize infrared reflection. Another innovation involved the five-layer sunshield, which protects the instruments from solar heat and light, maintaining the cryogenic temperatures necessary for infrared astronomy.
   According to the text, what were two key technological innovations of the James Webb Space Telescope?
   A. The use of beryllium segments and maintenance of cryogenic temperatures
   B. The hexagonal mirror design and infrared reflection capabilities
   C. The segmented primary mirror that unfolds and the multi-layer sunshield
   D. The gold coating on mirrors and protection from solar heat
3. Marine biologist Dr. Elena Torres hypothesizes that the bioluminescent displays of certain deep-sea jellyfish serve primarily as a defensive mechanism against predators rather than for attracting prey. She notes that these jellyfish typically emit brief, intense flashes of light when physically disturbed, which could temporarily disorient would-be attackers. Additionally, the light patterns produced resemble those of other, more dangerous organisms in their environment, potentially scaring away predators through mimicry.
   Which finding, if true, would most strongly support Dr. Torres's hypothesis?
   A. The jellyfish produce bioluminescent signals most frequently during feeding periods.
   B. Predatory fish show avoidance behavior when exposed to artificial lights mimicking the jellyfish's bioluminescent displays.
   C. The intensity of bioluminescence correlates with the jellyfish's nutritional status.
   D. Bioluminescent patterns vary significantly between individual jellyfish of the same species.
4. Economic historian Professor James Chen argues that the rapid industrialization of 19th-century Britain was facilitated not only by technological innovation but also by specific financial institutions. He points to the crucial role of joint-stock banks in mobilizing capital for industrial enterprises. These banks, by pooling resources from numerous small investors, could provide the substantial long-term financing that factory construction and machinery acquisition required.
   Which finding, if true, would most directly support Professor Chen's argument?

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A. Regions with higher concentrations of joint-stock banks showed faster rates of factory establishment between 1820-1850.
B. Technological patents filed during this period primarily came from individual inventors rather than corporations.
C. Joint-stock banks charged lower interest rates than private banks for agricultural loans.
D. Most industrial entrepreneurs during this period came from wealthy families with existing capital.

5. Table: Students' Preferred Study Methods and Average Exam Scores

Study Method	Percentage of Students	Average Exam Score (/100)
Reading notes only	25%	68
Practice problems	35%	82
Group discussion	20%	75
Video tutorials	15%	71
Mixed methods	5%	88

A university study investigated the relationship between students' preferred study methods and their academic performance. Researchers surveyed 400 undergraduate students about their primary study approach and correlated this data with their average exam scores across multiple courses.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the text?

A. Students who preferred practice problems achieved the highest average exam scores, with 82% scoring above 75.
B. 35% of students preferred practice problems, and this group achieved average exam scores of 82%.
C. Although only 5% of students used mixed methods, this group achieved the highest average exam score of 88%.
D. Students who relied solely on reading notes had the lowest average exam score at 68%, representing 25% of the sample.

6. When the research team introduced a new enrichment device into the chimpanzee enclosure, they observed a significant decrease in stereotypic behaviors such as pacing and self-grooming. The device, which required problem-solving to extract hidden food rewards, occupied the chimpanzees for extended periods. Over the following month, social interactions among group members increased by 40%, and aggressive encounters decreased notably.

Based on the text, what can reasonably be inferred about the effect of the enrichment device?

A. It directly caused a reduction in aggressive behavior by physically separating the chimpanzees.
B. It likely improved the chimpanzees' welfare by reducing boredom and stimulating natural foraging behaviors.
C. It was designed specifically to increase social interactions among group members.
D. It completely eliminated all stereotypic behaviors in the chimpanzee group.

7. Analysis of ice core samples from Antarctica has revealed atmospheric carbon dioxide concentrations over the past 800,000 years. Before the Industrial Revolution, CO_2 levels naturally fluctuated between 180 and 300 parts per million. Since the early 19th century, concentrations have risen dramatically, exceeding 400 ppm by 2015. Current levels are unprecedented in the entire 800,000-year record.

Which conclusion is most strongly supported by the text?

A. Natural fluctuations in CO_2 levels have ceased completely since the Industrial Revolution.
B. The rise in atmospheric CO_2 since the Industrial Revolution exceeds any natural variation in the past 800,000 years.
C. Ice core analysis cannot provide accurate data about atmospheric conditions beyond 800,000 years ago.
D. CO_2 levels were stable throughout human history until the Industrial Revolution.

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8. The restoration of the medieval manuscript was a _____ process, requiring conservators to work for months with minute brushes and specialized solvents to remove centuries of grime without damaging the fragile ink beneath.
   Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
   A. meticulous
   B. haphazard
   C. expeditious
   D. rudimentary
9. Despite initial skepticism from the scientific community, the young researcher's _____ approach to the problem ultimately yielded groundbreaking results that challenged conventional wisdom in the field.
   Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
   A. orthodox
   B. derivative
   C. unorthodox
   D. conventional
10. The composer's latest symphony represents a _____ from her earlier works; while she previously favored minimalist structures, this piece features complex, multi-layered orchestration and extended melodic developments.
    Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
    A. continuation
    B. regression
    C. departure
    D. culmination
11. In 2018, marine biologists discovered that some coral species in the Great Barrier Reef were developing a surprising resilience to rising ocean temperatures. While most corals undergo fatal bleaching when water temperatures increase, these particular specimens were producing higher concentrations of protective proteins that shielded their symbiotic algae from heat stress. This finding suggests that some corals may possess previously unknown adaptive mechanisms that could help them survive climate change.
    Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?
    A. It presents a newly discovered coral adaptation as evidence that some species might be more resilient to climate change than previously thought.
    B. It argues that ocean temperatures in the Great Barrier Reef are rising at an unsustainable rate that will inevitably destroy the ecosystem.
    C. It explains why most coral species undergo bleaching when exposed to elevated water temperatures.
    D. It describes the process by which corals produce protective proteins to shield their symbiotic algae.
12. Many people assume that the development of written language was primarily driven by the need for record-keeping in early agricultural societies. However, archaeological evidence suggests a more complex story. The earliest known writing systems, such as cuneiform in Mesopotamia, were indeed used for administrative purposes like tracking grain supplies. But they also quickly evolved to include literary, religious, and personal texts, indicating that the human impulse toward creative expression and communication played a significant role in writing's development from its inception.
    Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?
    A. It introduces evidence that complicates a common assumption about the development of writing.
    B. It presents the main conclusion that the text aims to prove through detailed examples.
    C. It provides a specific counterexample to the argument presented in the previous sentence.
    D. It summarizes the historical evidence that supports the text's central thesis.
13. The following text is from Charlotte Brontë's 1847 novel *Jane Eyre*.

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"I resisted all the way: a new thing for me, and a circumstance which greatly strengthened the bad opinion Bessie and Miss Abbot were disposed to entertain of me. The fact is, I was a trifle beside myself; or rather out of myself, as the French would say: I was conscious that a moment's mutiny had already rendered me liable to strange penalties, and, like any other rebel slave, I felt resolved, in my desperation, to go all lengths."

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A. It reveals the narrator's internal conflict and determination to resist oppression despite potential consequences.
B. It describes the French perspective on rebellion as contrasted with the English viewpoint.
C. It explains why Bessie and Miss Abbot developed a negative opinion of the narrator.
D. It outlines the specific penalties that rebels face in the narrator's society.

14. **Text 1:** Proponents of urban green spaces argue that parks and community gardens provide essential environmental benefits in cities. They point to research showing that vegetation helps reduce the "urban heat island" effect, where cities experience higher temperatures than surrounding rural areas. Trees and plants provide shade and release moisture through transpiration, naturally cooling their surroundings and reducing energy demands for air conditioning.

    Text 2: A 2021 study conducted in Melbourne, Australia, measured temperature differences between neighborhoods with varying levels of vegetation cover. Researchers found that areas with extensive tree canopy were up to 4°C cooler during summer heatwaves than nearby areas with minimal greenery. The study also documented a 15% reduction in residential air conditioning usage in well-vegetated neighborhoods, suggesting significant energy savings.

    Based on the texts, how would the researchers of the Melbourne study (Text 2) most likely describe the view presented in Text 1?

    A. It is theoretically sound but lacks the empirical evidence needed to convince urban planners.
    B. It accurately identifies key benefits of urban vegetation that their research quantitatively confirmed.
    C. It overlooks several important economic factors that affect the implementation of green spaces.
    D. It exaggerates the potential cooling effects of urban vegetation based on limited anecdotal evidence.

15. **Text 1:** Art historians have long debated whether the Renaissance represented a complete break from medieval artistic traditions or an evolution of existing practices. Some scholars emphasize the dramatic innovations in perspective, human anatomy, and classical inspiration that characterize Renaissance art, viewing it as a radical departure from the more symbolic and hierarchical compositions of the Middle Ages.

    Text 2: Recent exhibitions focusing on transitional works from the 14th and early 15th centuries reveal considerable continuity between late medieval and early Renaissance art. Many technical innovations attributed to Renaissance artists, such as experimental perspective systems, actually appeared gradually in the work of their medieval predecessors. The distinction between the two periods appears increasingly blurred upon closer examination of these transitional works.

    Based on the texts, how would the curators of the recent exhibitions (Text 2) most likely respond to the view of Renaissance art described in Text 1?

    A. They would agree that Renaissance art represented a complete break from medieval traditions.
    B. They would argue that the distinction between medieval and Renaissance art is more nuanced than a simple break.
    C. They would reject the notion that Renaissance artists employed any innovative techniques.
    D. They would contend that medieval art was superior to Renaissance art in its technical execution.

16. **Notes:**
    - Maya Lin designed the Vietnam Veterans Memorial in Washington, D.C.
    - The memorial was completed in 1982.
    - Lin was an undergraduate architecture student at Yale when she won the design competition.

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- The design features two black granite walls meeting at an angle.
- The walls are inscribed with the names of over 58,000 fallen soldiers.
- The memorial quickly became one of the most visited sites in Washington.

The student wants to emphasize the remarkable achievement of a young designer. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Maya Lin designed the Vietnam Veterans Memorial, which features two black granite walls inscribed with names and meets at an angle.
B. Completed in 1982, the Vietnam Veterans Memorial designed by Maya Lin quickly became one of Washington's most visited sites.
C. Maya Lin was still an undergraduate architecture student when she won the competition to design the Vietnam Veterans Memorial.
D. The Vietnam Veterans Memorial, designed by Maya Lin, honors over 58,000 fallen soldiers with its distinctive granite walls.

17. **Notes:**
- The Mars Rover Perseverance landed on Mars in February 2021.
- Its mission includes searching for signs of ancient microbial life.
- Perseverance collected the first rock core samples from another planet.
- The rover carries the Ingenuity helicopter, the first aircraft to fly on another planet.
- Perseverance will help prepare for future human missions to Mars.
- The rover's design builds on previous Mars rovers like Curiosity.

The student wants to highlight the historic nature of Perseverance's achievements. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Perseverance, which landed in 2021, carries the Ingenuity helicopter and searches for signs of ancient life.
B. Building on previous designs like Curiosity, Perseverance continues NASA's exploration of the Martian surface.
C. Perseverance achieved multiple historic firsts, including collecting the first rock cores from another planet and deploying the first aircraft to fly on Mars.
D. The Perseverance rover's mission includes preparing for future human exploration while searching for evidence of past microbial life.

18. **Notes:**
- The printing press was invented by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440.
- Moveable type technology had previously been developed in East Asia.
- Gutenberg's innovation combined several existing technologies.
- The printing press dramatically reduced the cost of producing books.
- Literacy rates increased significantly in Europe after its invention.
- The spread of ideas accelerated, contributing to the Renaissance and Reformation.

The student wants to illustrate Gutenberg's role in adapting existing technologies to create a transformative invention. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Johannes Gutenberg invented the printing press around 1440, which reduced book costs and increased literacy.
B. While moveable type existed previously, Gutenberg combined several technologies to create the printing press, revolutionizing information spread.
C. The printing press, invented by Gutenberg, accelerated the spread of ideas and contributed to major historical movements.
D. Gutenberg's printing press built on East Asian moveable type but achieved greater impact in Europe.

19. **Notes:**
- The deep sea is characterized by extreme pressure, near-freezing temperatures, and complete darkness.
- Despite these harsh conditions, diverse ecosystems thrive around hydrothermal vents.
- Chemosynthetic bacteria form the base of these food chains.
- These bacteria convert chemicals from vent fluids into energy.

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- Unique species like tube worms and yeti crabs depend on these bacteria.
- Hydrothermal vent communities were discovered in 1977.

The student wants to explain how life survives in deep-sea hydrothermal vent ecosystems. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Hydrothermal vent communities, discovered in 1977, include unique species like tube worms in complete darkness.
B. Chemosynthetic bacteria convert vent chemicals into energy, supporting diverse ecosystems in harsh deep-sea conditions.
C. The deep sea has extreme pressure and cold temperatures, yet diverse ecosystems thrive around hydrothermal vents.
D. Unique species like yeti crabs depend on bacteria that form the base of hydrothermal vent food chains.

20. The mathematician's proof was elegant in its simplicity; _____, it required such advanced conceptual understanding that few of her contemporaries could fully appreciate its significance.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. therefore,
B. moreover,
C. however,
D. specifically,

21. The archaeological site showed evidence of continuous human habitation for over three millennia. _____, artifacts from the earliest settlement layers demonstrated sophisticated pottery techniques that researchers had previously associated with much later periods.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. For example,
B. Nevertheless,
C. Similarly,
D. Consequently,

22. The research team had expected to find minimal biological activity in the ultra-dry environment of the Atacama Desert. _____, their soil samples revealed a surprising diversity of microbial life adapted to extreme aridity.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. However,
B. Accordingly,
C. Furthermore,
D. Likewise,

23. The restoration of the historic theater _____ involved repairing the ornate ceiling frescoes, which had been damaged by water leakage over several decades.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. painstakingly
B. painstakingly,
C. painstakingly;
D. painstakingly:

24. Scientists studying bird migration patterns _____ have discovered that some species use the Earth's magnetic field for navigation, a capability that remains poorly understood.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. recently
B. recently,
C. recently;
D. recently:

25. The composer's final symphony _____ remained unfinished for nearly a century before a musicologist reconstructed the missing movements based on the existing sketches and thematic materials.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. unfortunately

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B. unfortunately,
C. unfortunately;
D. unfortunately:

26. _____ the team analyzed sediment cores from the lake bottom, they discovered pollen grains that provided a detailed record of historical climate conditions in the region.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. When
B. Although
C. Nevertheless
D. Besides

27. The development of quantum computing represents _____ classical computing, with potential applications in cryptography, drug discovery, and complex system modeling.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. a significant advance beyond
B. significantly advancing beyond
C. having significantly advanced beyond
D. to significantly advance beyond

MODULE 2: Reading and Writing (27 Questions)

Directions:

The questions in this section address a number of important reading and writing skills. Each question includes one or more passages, which may include a table or graph. Read each passage and question carefully, and then choose the best answer to the question based on the passage(s).

All questions in this section are multiple-choice with four answer choices. Each question has a single best answer.

1. The phenomenon of "island gigantism" occurs when isolated island species evolve to become significantly larger than their mainland relatives. This evolutionary pattern is particularly well-documented in the case of the Komodo dragon, which developed its massive size after reaching Indonesian islands where it faced minimal competition and predation. Similarly, the now-extinct moa birds of New Zealand grew to heights of over 3.5 meters in the absence of mammalian predators.
Which choice best states the main idea of the text?
A. Komodo dragons and moa birds represent the most extreme examples of island gigantism ever discovered.
B. Island gigantism describes how isolated species sometimes evolve larger sizes due to reduced competition and predation.
C. The absence of mammalian predators directly causes all island species to grow larger than their mainland counterparts.
D. Evolutionary biology focuses primarily on understanding size variations between island and mainland species.

2. The discovery of the Antikythera mechanism in 1901 revolutionized our understanding of ancient Greek technology. This complex bronze device, dating from the 2nd century BCE, contained precisely cut gears that could predict astronomical positions and eclipses decades in advance. Recent imaging has revealed inscriptions that functioned as an ancient "instruction manual," demonstrating that the mechanism could track the cycles of the Olympic Games and other Panhellenic festivals.
According to the text, what were two functions of the Antikythera mechanism?
A. Predicting astronomical events and tracking athletic competitions
B. Calculating maritime navigation routes and measuring time
C. Recording historical events and predicting weather patterns
D. Mapping celestial bodies and measuring geological time

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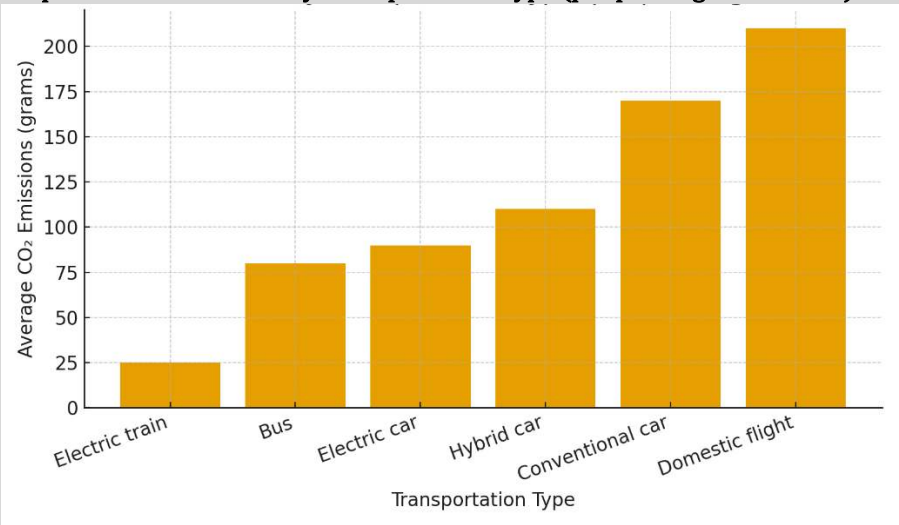
3. Dr. Isabella Chen, a materials scientist, hypothesizes that the exceptional durability of ancient Roman concrete results from a unique self-healing property. She suggests that the inclusion of quicklime in the Roman mixture creates reactive calcium deposits that automatically fill cracks when water penetrates. This process would explain why Roman maritime structures like the Port of Caesarea have survived 2,000 years of wave action while modern concrete deteriorates within decades.
   Which finding, if true, would most strongly support Dr. Chen's hypothesis?
   A. Laboratory analysis reveals microscopic calcium-filled cracks in Roman concrete samples exposed to seawater.
   B. Roman concrete mixtures contained higher proportions of volcanic ash than modern concrete formulas.
   C. Historical records indicate that Roman engineers intentionally used seawater in their concrete mixtures.
   D. Modern concrete formulations that include quicklime show reduced cracking in accelerated aging tests.
4. Economic anthropologist Dr. Marcus Thorne argues that the earliest forms of money emerged not as tools for commercial exchange but as mechanisms for maintaining social relationships. He points to historical evidence from Pacific Island societies where elaborate shell necklaces and armbands circulated in ceremonial exchanges that reinforced alliances and social hierarchies rather than facilitating market transactions.
   Which finding, if true, would most directly support Dr. Thorne's argument?
   A. Archaeological evidence shows that the most valuable shell ornaments were typically buried with high-status individuals rather than used in daily trade.
   B. Shell ornaments from different Pacific Islands show remarkable similarity in design and manufacturing technique.
   C. Modern economic models can accurately predict the exchange rates between different types of traditional shell money.
   D. The production of shell ornaments required specialized skills that were monopolized by certain family groups.
5. **Graph: Carbon Emissions by Transportation Type (per passenger kilometer)**



   A urban planning committee is evaluating transportation options based on their environmental impact. The table shows average carbon dioxide emissions per passenger kilometer for different modes of transport.
   Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the text?
   A. Electric trains produce only 25 grams of CO_2 per passenger kilometer, while domestic flights produce 210 grams, making trains eight times more efficient.
   B. Buses emit 80 grams of CO_2 per passenger kilometer, which is significantly less than conventional cars at 170 grams.

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C. Electric cars at 90 grams and hybrid cars at 110 grams both emit less CO_2 than conventional cars at 170 grams.
D. Domestic flights have the highest emissions at 210 grams per passenger kilometer, followed by conventional cars at 170 grams.

6. When researchers introduced wolves to Yellowstone National Park in 1995 after a 70-year absence, they observed unexpected ecological changes. The wolves reduced elk populations, which allowed willow and aspen trees to recover from overgrazing. This vegetation recovery in turn stabilized riverbanks and created habitat for beavers, whose dams further modified the landscape to support additional species. The changes demonstrated how a single predator species can influence entire ecosystem structure.
Based on the text, what can reasonably be inferred about the role of wolves in the Yellowstone ecosystem?
A. Their presence creates cascading effects that extend beyond simple predator-prey relationships.
B. They primarily function to control elk populations through direct predation.
C. Their ecological impact is limited to areas near rivers and streams.
D. They compete directly with beavers for habitat and resources.

7. Analysis of linguistic patterns across 600 languages reveals that languages spoken in colder climates tend to use more vowels and simpler syllable structures. Researchers hypothesize that this pattern may result from the physical constraints of speaking in cold air, which can make complex consonant clusters more difficult to articulate. Languages from Arctic regions, for instance, show significantly higher vowel-to-consonant ratios than those from tropical areas.
Which conclusion is most strongly supported by the text?
A. Environmental factors may influence the phonological development of languages.
B. All languages evolve toward simpler structures over time regardless of climate.
C. Cold climate languages are inherently easier to learn than warm climate languages.
D. The vowel-to-consonant ratio determines a language's adaptability to different environments.

8. The historian's analysis of the political movement was remarkably _____; she managed to synthesize decades of complex ideological developments into a coherent narrative without oversimplifying the significant philosophical divisions that shaped the movement's trajectory.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
A. lucid
B. verbose
C. ambiguous
D. superficial

9. The scientific community initially viewed the young researcher's theory with considerable _____, but as experimental evidence accumulated, skepticism gradually gave way to widespread acceptance.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
A. enthusiasm
B. skepticism
C. indifference
D. reverence

10. The architect's design for the new museum was praised for its _____ integration of historical elements with contemporary aesthetics, creating a structure that respectfully acknowledged the past while firmly embracing the present.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
A. awkward
B. seamless
C. tentative
D. disruptive

11. While many assume that medieval European medicine was purely superstitious, recent scholarship reveals a more complex reality. Medical practitioners of the era employed surprisingly sophisticated diagnostic techniques, including urine analysis, pulse reading, and systematic

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observation of symptoms. University-trained physicians studied translated Arabic and Greek medical texts that contained detailed anatomical knowledge. Although their understanding of disease causation was limited by contemporary beliefs, their clinical methods often followed logical, observation-based principles.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A. It contrasts medieval European medicine with earlier Greek and Arabic medical traditions.
B. It challenges the oversimplified view of medieval medicine as entirely unscientific.
C. It argues that urine analysis was the most important diagnostic tool in medieval medicine.
D. It explains why medieval physicians failed to understand the true causes of disease.

12. The following text is from Charles Dickens' 1854 novel *Hard Times*.

"It was a town of red brick, or of brick that would have been red if the smoke and ashes had allowed it; but as matters stood it was a town of unnatural red and black like the painted face of a savage. It was a town of machinery and tall chimneys, out of which interminable serpents of smoke trailed themselves for ever and ever, and never got uncoiled."

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A. It uses vivid imagery to emphasize the pervasive industrial pollution affecting the town.
B. It provides specific technical details about the manufacturing processes used in the town.
C. It contrasts the natural beauty of the area with the damaging effects of industrialization.
D. It explains the economic benefits that the factories brought to the town's residents.

13. Many people believe that the development of agriculture was an unequivocal advancement for human societies. However, analysis of skeletal remains from early agricultural communities tells a different story. These remains show evidence of nutritional deficiencies, increased infectious disease, and reduced stature compared to their hunter-gatherer predecessors. The transition to agriculture, while enabling population growth and permanent settlements, appears to have come at significant cost to individual health and well-being.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A. It presents evidence that complicates the view of agricultural development as purely beneficial.
B. It argues that hunter-gatherer societies were healthier than all agricultural societies.
C. It explains why nutritional deficiencies were common in early agricultural communities.
D. It describes the skeletal analysis techniques used by archaeologists studying ancient remains.

14. **Text 1:** Proponents of the "cognitive reserve" hypothesis argue that education and intellectually stimulating activities throughout life help build neural connections that protect against age-related cognitive decline. This theory suggests that individuals with higher levels of cognitive engagement develop alternative neural pathways that can compensate for damage caused by neurodegenerative diseases like Alzheimer's.

Text 2: A longitudinal study tracking 1,200 older adults found that those who regularly engaged in mentally challenging activities—such as learning new languages, playing musical instruments, or solving complex puzzles—showed 30% slower rates of memory decline than their less-engaged peers. Brain scans revealed that the mentally active group maintained greater neural connectivity in regions typically affected by aging.

Based on the texts, how would the researchers of the longitudinal study (Text 2) most likely describe the hypothesis presented in Text 1?

A. It is theoretically plausible but lacks empirical support from controlled studies.
B. It accurately describes a neuroprotective mechanism that their research appears to validate.
C. It overstates the potential benefits of cognitive engagement for preventing dementia.
D. It fails to account for genetic factors that primarily determine cognitive aging.

15. **Text 1:** Art critics in the early 20th century often dismissed Vincent van Gogh's work as technically crude and emotionally excessive. His bold brushwork, intense colors, and expressive distortions were frequently characterized as signs of amateurish inability rather than artistic innovation. During his lifetime, van Gogh sold very few paintings and struggled to gain recognition from the established art world.

Text 2: The 2017 exhibition "Van Gogh and Japan" at the Van Gogh Museum highlighted the artist's deep engagement with Japanese woodblock prints, which influenced his distinctive approach to

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composition and color. The exhibition demonstrated how van Gogh systematically studied and adapted Japanese aesthetic principles, developing his revolutionary style through deliberate artistic choices rather than technical limitations.

Based on the texts, how would the curators of the 2017 exhibition (Text 2) most likely respond to the early critics described in Text 1?

A. They would agree that van Gogh's techniques resulted from his lack of formal training.
B. They would argue that van Gogh's style reflected conscious artistic innovation influenced by cross-cultural study.
C. They would contend that Japanese art had no significant impact on van Gogh's development.
D. They would acknowledge that van Gogh's emotional state prevented him from developing technical proficiency.

16. **Notes:**
- Rosalind Franklin was a chemist and X-ray crystallographer.
- Her Photo 51 provided crucial evidence of DNA's helical structure.
- James Watson and Francis Crick used her data without her permission.
- Franklin died in 1958, four years before Watson and Crick received the Nobel Prize.
- Nobel rules prohibit posthumous awards, making Franklin ineligible.
- Franklin's contributions were largely unrecognized during her lifetime.

The student wants to emphasize the historical injustice in the recognition of DNA's discovery. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Rosalind Franklin's Photo 51 provided key evidence for the DNA double helix, but she died before Watson and Crick received the Nobel Prize for this discovery.
B. James Watson and Francis Crick used Rosalind Franklin's data without permission to determine DNA's structure.
C. Rosalind Franklin was a chemist whose work was essential to understanding DNA, but Nobel rules prevented her from sharing in the prize awarded to Watson and Crick.
D. The Nobel Prize was awarded to Watson and Crick in 1962 for discovering DNA's structure, four years after Rosalind Franklin's death.

17. **Notes:**
- The Hubble Space Telescope was launched in 1990 with a flawed mirror.
- The flaw caused blurry images that initially made the telescope ineffective.
- A 1993 servicing mission installed corrective optics that fixed the problem.
- Hubble has since made numerous groundbreaking discoveries.
- The telescope has been serviced five times by space shuttle missions.
- Hubble remains operational more than 30 years after its launch.

The student wants to highlight the successful recovery of the Hubble mission after its initial failure. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. The Hubble Space Telescope, launched in 1990, has been serviced five times and remains operational after 30 years.
B. Despite beginning with a flawed mirror that produced blurry images, Hubble was repaired in 1993 and went on to make major discoveries.
C. Hubble's corrective optics installed in 1993 solved the mirror problem that had plagued the telescope since its 1990 launch.
D. The Hubble Space Telescope made numerous discoveries after its 1993 repair mission fixed its initially flawed mirror.

18. **Notes:**
- The Guttenberg Bible was printed around 1455 in Mainz, Germany.
- It was the first major book printed using movable type in Europe.
- Approximately 180 copies were printed, about 50 on vellum and 130 on paper.
- 49 complete or substantially complete copies survive today.
- The invention revolutionized the spread of information in Europe.
- The Bible is named after Johannes Gutenberg, who developed the printing press.

The student wants to emphasize the historical significance and rarity of the Gutenberg Bible. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

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A. The Gutenberg Bible, printed around 1455, was the first major European book printed with movable type, and only 49 of the original 180 copies survive today.
B. Johannes Gutenberg invented the printing press and used it to print Bibles in Mainz, Germany, revolutionizing information spread.
C. About 180 Gutenberg Bibles were printed on vellum and paper, with the invention of movable type making mass book production possible.
D. The Gutenberg Bible, named after Johannes Gutenberg, was printed in the 1450s and represented a major advancement in book production technology.

19. **Notes:**
- The human microbiome consists of trillions of microorganisms living in and on the human body.
- These microbes outnumber human cells by about 10 to 1.
- The gut microbiome helps digest food, produce vitamins, and train the immune system.
- Imbalances in microbiome composition are linked to various diseases.
- Antibiotics can disrupt healthy microbiome communities.
- Research suggests microbiome health affects mental health through the gut-brain axis.

The student wants to explain the importance of the human microbiome for overall health. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?
A. The human microbiome contains trillions of microorganisms that perform essential functions like aiding digestion and immune function, with imbalances linked to disease.
B. Microbiome research has revealed connections between gut health and mental health through the gut-brain axis, showing complex body systems interactions.
C. Antibiotics can disrupt the human microbiome, which consists of microbes outnumbering human cells 10 to 1 and living throughout the body.
D. The human microbiome helps digest food and produce vitamins while being susceptible to disruption by antibiotics and other factors.

20. The research team had planned to conduct their field study during the dry season; _____, unexpected heavy rains forced them to postpone their data collection for several months.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. however,
B. therefore,
C. moreover,
D. consequently,

21. The ancient city's water management system was remarkably sophisticated. _____, archaeologists have uncovered evidence of covered drains, settling tanks, and public wells that provided clean water to residents while efficiently managing wastewater.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. For instance,
B. Nevertheless,
C. Accordingly,
D. Similarly,

22. The composer's early works were characterized by traditional harmonic structures and conventional instrumentation; _____, her later compositions embraced dissonance and incorporated electronic elements alongside classical orchestration.
Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A. in contrast,
B. as a result,
C. additionally,
D. namely,

23. The conservation team worked _____ for over two years to restore the damaged mural to its original vibrancy, using microscopic tools and custom-mixed pigments to match the artist's technique.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

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A. meticulously
B. meticulously,
C. meticulously;
D. meticulously:

24. The research findings were _____ according to the lead scientist, conclusive enough to warrant immediate changes to the clinical trial protocol.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. according to the lead scientist conclusive enough
B. according to the lead scientist, conclusive enough
C. according to the lead scientist; conclusive enough
D. according to the lead scientist—conclusive enough

25. The archaeological discovery _____ which included perfectly preserved textiles and wooden tools, has forced historians to reconsider the technological capabilities of ancient civilizations.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. which included perfectly preserved textiles and wooden tools has
B. which included perfectly preserved textiles and wooden tools, has
C. which included perfectly preserved textiles and wooden tools; has
D. which included perfectly preserved textiles and wooden tools—has

26. _____ analyzing climate data from ice cores, scientists have reconstructed temperature patterns stretching back 800,000 years, providing crucial context for understanding current climate change.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. By
B. Despite
C. Whereas
D. Until

27. The development of CRISPR gene-editing technology represents _____ conventional genetic engineering, with potential applications in medicine, agriculture, and biotechnology.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A. a revolutionary advance beyond
B. revolutionarily advancing beyond
C. having revolutionarily advanced beyond
D. to revolutionarily advance beyond

BACKUP QUESTIONS

1. **Text 1:** Proponents of the "simulation hypothesis" argue that advanced civilizations would inevitably create simulated realities, and given the vast age of the universe, it is statistically likely that we are living in such a simulation rather than base reality. They point to apparent mathematical fine-tuning in physical constants and quantum mechanical phenomena that could be interpreted as computational optimizations or limitations.
Text 2: Theoretical physicist Dr. Sabine Hossenfelder contends that the simulation hypothesis, while philosophically intriguing, lacks falsifiable predictions and therefore falls outside the realm of scientific inquiry. She notes that any observable evidence cited by simulation proponents can be equally well explained by conventional physical laws, making the hypothesis untestable through empirical means. Furthermore, she argues that the computational requirements for simulating consciousness at the quantum level would be prohibitive even for advanced civilizations.
Based on the texts, how would Dr. Hossenfelder (Text 2) most likely respond to the statistical argument presented in Text 1?
A. She would agree that the statistical reasoning makes the simulation hypothesis highly probable.
B. She would argue that without testable predictions, statistical arguments alone cannot elevate the hypothesis to scientific status.
C. She would contend that quantum phenomena provide definitive evidence against the simulation hypothesis.

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D. She would acknowledge that computational limitations make the hypothesis plausible but unverifiable.

2. The philosopher's critique of technological determinism was particularly _____, exposing the unexamined assumptions underlying the notion that technology develops according to an inherent logic independent of human choices and cultural values. Her analysis revealed how this perspective often serves to legitimize technological developments by presenting them as inevitable rather than as products of specific social and economic decisions.
   Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
   A. incisive
   B. obfuscating
   C. derivative
   D. laudatory
3. **Notes:**
   - The Anthropocene is a proposed geological epoch marking significant human impact on Earth's systems.
   - Potential start dates include the Neolithic Revolution, Industrial Revolution, or Atomic Age.
   - Marker candidates: plastic pollution, radioactive isotopes from nuclear tests, altered sediment patterns.
   - The International Commission on Stratigraphy must approve the formal designation.
   - Critics argue the term overemphasizes human unity and masks differential responsibility for environmental damage.
   - Supporters contend it provides crucial conceptual framework for addressing global environmental challenges.

   The student wants to present a balanced overview of the Anthropocene debate. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?
   A. The Anthropocene concept highlights human environmental impact through markers like plastic pollution and radioactive isotopes, though critics note it may oversimplify responsibility for this damage.
   B. While the International Commission on Stratigraphy considers formal designation of the Anthropocene epoch, supporters and critics debate its start date and conceptual usefulness.
   C. Proposed as a new geological epoch marking human impact, the Anthropocene has supporters who value its conceptual framework and critics who question its simplification of differential responsibility.
   D. The Anthropocene debate involves determining start dates from the Neolithic to Atomic Age while considering markers like altered sediments and addressing criticisms about overemphasizing human unity.

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